Paleontology The study of fossils and biology of Earth's geological past. Paleobotany is the branch studying plant fossils.

Parasite An organism that lives on or in another organism, and obtains nutrients from its host.

Pesticides Chemicals used to kill certain types of pest in order to protect cultivated plants. They can, however, also kill nontarget species and damage the wider ecosystem.

Photosynthesis The process by which plants and algae transfer the Sun's light energy into chemical energy as glucose, allowing it to be passed along the food chain. The process absorbs carbon dioxide and releases oxygen.

Physiology A branch of biology that focuses on the everyday functioning of organisms.

Pollination The transfer of pollen from a male plant part to a female one—by birds, insects, and other animals, or by the wind—enabling fertilization and seed production.

Pollution The introduction of harmful contaminants to the natural environment, inducing changes to the atmosphere.

Predator A species that hunts other animal species for food.

Prey A species that is hunted by another species.

Primary producer Any organism that makes its own food from nonorganic sources, namely light and/or chemical compounds such as carbon dioxide and sulfur, and thus sustains the animals that feed on it.

Primary vegetation The vegetation that has prevailed in a given area since the start of its current climatic conditions.

Recycling The process of converting waste into new objects or materials, or burning it to generate energy.

Renewables Fuel sources that are not finite, such as solar power, hydropower, and wind power.